

Paperluz Industry Weekly · Issue 001

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Core Theme: North American Containerboard Supply Contraction × Asian Pulp Price Bottom Consolidation × EU Packaging Regulation Countdown

China Import NBSK Pulp Spot

\$675 / MT

RMB 4,826/t · Soft/Hardwood spread narrows to \$45/MT

US OCC #11 Export FAS

\$130–135

USD/short ton · Fiber costs flat · Mill Spread expands

NA / EU Containerboard Hikes

+\$140 / +€120

PCA / IP / Smurfit dominant seller's market · Sept 1 effective

EU PPWR Mandatory Law

Countdown: 7 Days

2026-08-12 mandatory · DfR compliance audit alert

China Ivory Board Hike

+\$28 / MT

+RMB 200/MT · Nine Dragons & APP lead July 1 increase

Long Chen June Revenue YoY

+44.10%

\$146M USD (NT\$4.71B) · 4-year high · H1 profitable turnaround

I. Executive 10-Line Summary & Key Insights

- 1. North American Containerboard Firm Seller's Market Established:** PCA (+\$140/t), IP (+\$80/t), and Smurfit Westrock (+\$100/t) continue pushing realization, underpinned by 3.9M MT of permanent Americas mill capacity closures.
- 2. European Structural Consolidation & Elevated Packaging Board:** Stora Enso and UPM continue closing unprofitable graphic paper lines; Smurfit Westrock's European containerboard surged +€120/MT (+\$131/MT) in Q2.
- 3. Chinese 4.0M MT Surplus Capacity Seeking Overseas Outlets:** Nine Dragons and Lee & Man are actively expanding containerboard exports to Southeast Asia and the Middle East.
- 4. Asian Virgin Pulp Bottom Consolidation & Extreme Spread Narrowing:** China NBSK averaged \$675/MT (RMB 4,826) and BHKP \$628/MT (RMB 4,501). The spread collapsed to just \$45/MT (\$168 historical average), halting hardwood substitution.
- 5. Japanese Natural Disasters Disrupt Specialty Supply Chains:** Nippon Paper's Yatsushiro mill emergency shutdown following the Kumamoto earthquake impacts specialty paper supplies.
- 6. US OCC Export Prices Hold Steady at Highs:** US #11 OCC export FAS holds at \$130–135/short ton, widening mill Raw Material Spreads to multi-year highs.
- 7. China "Anti-Involution" Industrial Paper Price Hikes Take Effect:** +RMB 200/MT on ivory board and +RMB

50/MT on fluting taking root under GB 31825-2024 energy quota discipline.

8. Taiwanese Top 4 Paper Mills Performance Diverges: Long Chen June revenue jumped +44.10% YoY (\$146M USD); Cheng Loong passed through +10% packaging hikes; YFY maintained steady growth.

9. Dual EU Packaging & Environmental Regulations in Critical Countdown: PPWR takes effect in 7 days (2026-08-12); BPA ban under (EU) 2024/3190 explicitly covers inks and adhesives.

10. Carbon Fees and EUDR Supply Chain Traceability Take Root: Mills accelerating biomass conversions ahead of 2026 carbon fees; EUDR countdown at 147 days.

II. Key Indicators Dashboard

2.1 Raw Material Benchmarks (Virgin Wood Pulp)

Indicator	Latest Value (USD)	Benchmark Date	Change	Market Interpretation & Trend
China NBSK Spot Nationwide Avg	\$675 / MT (RMB 4,826)	2026-08-04	-2.8% MoM	Softwood costs at multi-year lows; bottoming out
China BHKP Spot Nationwide Avg	\$628 / MT (RMB 4,501)	2026-08-04	Flat	Hardwood resilient; Suzano Cerrado volume absorbs spikes
Asian USD Benchmark NBSK / BHKP	\$680 / \$610 per MT	2026-08	Flat	South American mills maintain dual-track pricing
SHFE Bleached Softwood Futures	\$669 / MT (RMB 4,785)	2026-08-04	Slight dip	Market sentiment stabilizing; no panic selling
China Major Port Pulp Inventories	2.285 Million MT	2026-08-01	-17k MT WoW	4th consecutive week of destocking; inventories elevated
Suzano Net Realized Export Price	\$562 / MT	2026-Q1	+1.0% YoY	Real transaction benchmark, structurally discounted to list

2.2 Recovered Fiber Benchmarks (Waste Paper / OCC)

Indicator	Latest Value (USD)	Benchmark Date	Change	Market Interpretation
US Domestic OCC Cumulative Hikes	+\$100 / short ton	2026-08	Flat	North American domestic demand firm; fiber cost support strong

Indicator	Latest Value (USD)	Benchmark Date	Change	Market Interpretation
US #11 OCC Export (East Coast FAS)	\$132–135 / short ton	2026-08	Flat	Asian buyers purchasing on-demand; freight limits bidding
US #11 OCC Export (West Coast FAS)	\$130–133 / short ton	2026-08	Flat	Container routing smooth; range-bound price action
Taiwan Domestic OCC Delivered Mill	\$130 / MT (NT\$4,200)	2026-08-04	Flat	Domestic collection stable; mill feedstock costs manageable

2.3 Paperboard & Finished Packaging Actions

Region	Product Category	Announced Action	Effective Date	Impact Scope
United States	Containerboard / Linerboard	PCA +\$140/t , IP +\$80/t , Smurfit +\$100/t	2026-09-01	Industrial packaging, corrugated boxes
Europe	Containerboard	Smurfit Westrock Q2 cumulative +€120/MT	2026-Q2	European industrial packaging, export supply chain
United States	Solid Bleached Sulfate (SBS)	Smurfit Westrock +4–6%; Sappi +4–6%	Aug 10, 24, Sept 1	Folding cartons, cosmetic & food board
China	Ivory Board (inc. Food Grade)	Nine Dragons, APP, Chenming +RMB 200/MT (+\$28)	2026-07-01	Extrusion cups, food packaging
Taiwan	Industrial Paper & Cartons	Cheng Loong +10% , phase-in	May 2026+	Corrugated boxes, electronics & agri packaging

III. Price Trends & Full-Chain Forward Matrix

Chart 1 | NBSK vs. BHKP Virgin Pulp Spread (\$/MT)

Spread narrows to historical low of \$45/MT, halting hardwood substitution

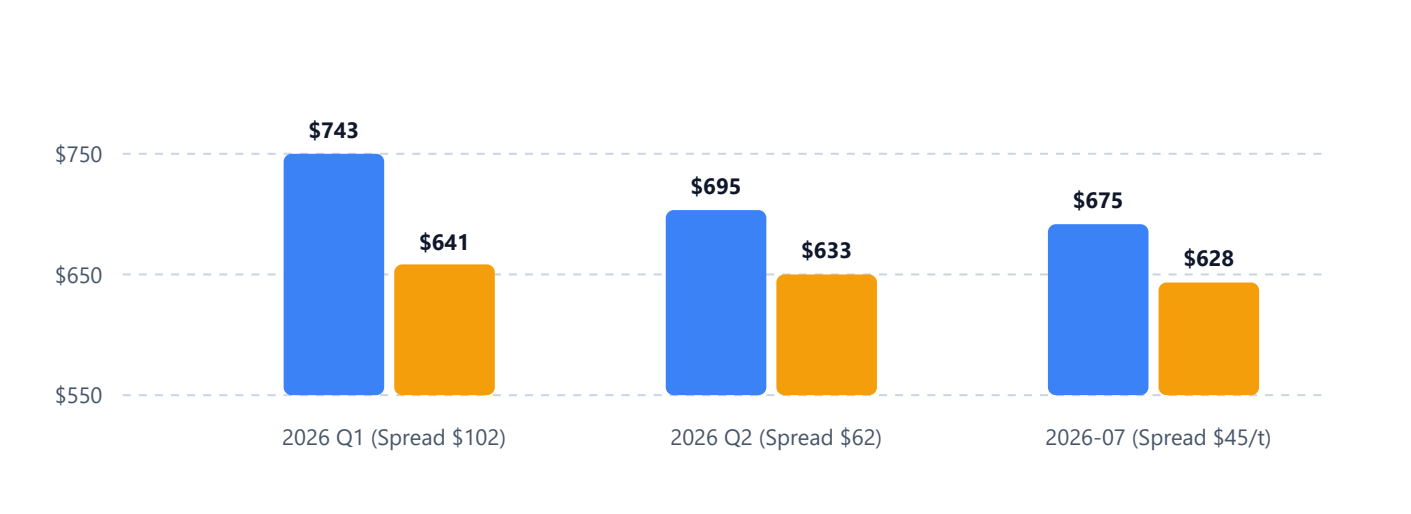


Chart 1 Analysis: The softwood-hardwood spread narrowed from \$102 in Q1 to \$45/MT (RMB 325/MT). Softwood prices have reached a multi-year cost support floor.

3.6 Full-Chain Forward Forecast Matrix (Energy × Pulp × Paper)

Commodity	Base	1M Outlook	3M Outlook	6M Outlook	Trend	Primary Drivers
Brent Crude	\$81.30/bbl	\$79–84	\$76–82	\$73–80	Softening	OPEC+ quota cuts & refinery maintenance ease resin/freight costs
Taiwan Coal CIF	\$143.5/MT	\$138–145	\$132–140	\$128–136	Declining	Australian supply ample; mill biomass keeps steaming costs at \$22–24.5/MT
NBSK Softwood	\$675/MT	\$668–685	\$678–713	\$699–741	Rebound	Cost floor holds; spread tight; hardwood substitution; restocking
BHKP Hardwood	\$628/MT	\$608–629	\$594–622	\$601–636	Range-bound	Suzano Cerberus 2.55M MT ramp-up of rebound momentum
Containerboard	+\$140 / +10%	Full Realization	Firm (+30\$)	Upward Cycle	Bullish	Americas 3.5M MT closure; Cheng Loo; Long Chen benefit

IV. Global Corporate Scanner & Mill Dynamics

Company	Period	Revenue / Earnings	YoY Growth	Strategic Analysis & Highlights
Cheng Loong (1904.TW)	2026-06	\$119.5M USD (NT\$3.88B)	-2.09% (+5.0% H1)	+10% domestic packaging hike passed through; Vietnam utilization reached 90%.
Long Chen (1909.TW)	2026-06	\$145.1M USD (NT\$4.71B)	+44.10%	June revenue hit 4-year high; Chinese packaging operations turned profitable.
YFY (1907.TW)	2026-06	\$203.4M USD (NT\$6.60B)	+12.66% (+4.4% H1)	Specialty chemicals and consumer products driving stable consolidated expansion.
Chung Hwa Pulp (1905.TW)	2026-06	\$46.7M USD (NT\$1.52B)	-0.43% (-5.1% H1)	Expanding plastic-free barrier board and bioenergy to counter graphic paper decline.
Suzano (Brazil)	2026-Q1	\$562 / MT Net Realized	+1.0% YoY	Cerrado 2.55M MT line fully operational; unbeatable cash cost below \$200/MT.
Smurfit Westrock	2026-Q2	+€120/MT (Europe)	Sold Out	European containerboard sold out; Raw Material Spread at multi-year record.

V. Global Regulations & 90-Day Milestones

Date	Days Out	Regulation / Commercial Milestone	Impacted Sectors
2026-08-10	5 Days	Smurfit Westrock Folding Boxboard / SBS +4–6% Effective	Folding cartons, food boxes
2026-08-12	7 Days	EU PPWR Mandatory Enforcement Date (All EU-bound packaging)	Global export packaging
2026-08-20	15 Days	Sappi Paperboard Grades +4–6% Effective	Merchants, converters
2026-09-01	27 Days	PCA +\$140 / IP +\$80 / Smurfit +\$100 Containerboard Hikes	Containerboard, boxmakers
2026-09-02	28 Days	China GB 4806.10-2025 Food Contact Coating Mandate	Paper cups, food containers
2026-10-11	67 Days	EU PFHxA Total PFAS Ban in Food Packaging	Greaseproof barrier board

Date	Days Out	Regulation / Commercial Milestone	Impacted Sectors
2026-12-30	147 Days	EU EUDR Deforestation Regulation Enforcement	All pulp & paper exporters

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All benchmark data is sourced from 59 globally registered authorities, verified through 4-tier AI cross-audits, and preserved in immutable SQLite database version control.

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